

Case Analysis Assignments

BUAD-304 | Organizational Behavior and Leadership

Instructor: Christine El Haddad

Term: Fall 2026

Assignment Summary

Grade weight: 5%

Group project: Yes

Related Mentions

- Our Inclusive Learning Community
- USC is a multicultural community of people from diverse gender, racial, ethnic and class backgrounds, national origins, faith backgrounds, political beliefs, abilities, and sexual orientations. Our lectures, classes, programs, workshops, activities and everyday interactions are enriched by our acceptance of one another, and we strive to learn from each other in an atmosphere of mutual respect and positive engagement.
- As Trojans, we understand the value of the perspectives of individuals from all backgrounds that reflect the rich diversity of our USC community and beyond. Together, we will strive to make this classroom a psychologically safe and inclusive environment for all of us to develop and practice inclusive behaviors.
- As such, we will:
 - respect the dignity and essential work of all individuals,
 - promote a culture of respect within the university community,
 - respect the privacy, property, and freedom of others,
 - reject bigotry, discrimination, violence or intimidation of any kind,
 - practice personal and academic integrity and expect it of others, and
 - promote the diversity of opinions, ideas and backgrounds which is the lifeblood of the university.
- Course Materials
- (1) Textbook & Connect/LearnSmart. You will need the ONLINE version of Organizational Behavior: A Practical, Problem-Solving Approach 3rd edition by Angelo Kinicki. 2021. McGraw Hill.
- USC has a new Digital Course Materials Program which provides access to many required textbooks, case studies and other resources for one flat fee. Our course materials have been submitted to the program coordinator and students have been sent notification about how to access the materials. Please check your

- usc.edu email for instructions on how to access the materials. I strongly recommend you access the textbook
- through this program, as the price for the e-book and Connect will be a significant discount relative to
- purchasing the book independent from the Course Materials Program.
- To gain access to the required ONLINE version of our textbook, Organizational Behavior: A Practical,
- Problem-Solving Approach, 3rd edition by Angelo Kinicki (2021) via Brightspace, follow these
- instructions to register directly with McGraw Hill.
- 1. Sign in to Brightspace.
- 2. Go to our BUAD 304 Organizational Behavior and Leadership course.
- 3. Under Content, find the Connect module and go to that module.
- 4. Click on one of the assignments in the Connect module (e.g., What is My Big Five Personality Profile),
- and you will jump over to the McGraw Hill website to register and access the e-book.
- 5. Please review the video at this link for additional information.
- (2) ARES Course Reader. This course reader is accessible for free on the USC Libraries ARES system
- online. Go to the online ARES system, click on Search Courses and search by course number: 304 for
- Fall 2026. Once you find the BUAD 304 course, add it then click View Course to view and access the
- readings.
- (3) Case reader. The BUAD 304 Organizational Behavior & Leadership coursepack for Fall 2026 can be
- accessed via the email sent to you.
- Additional Readings, Resources and Assessments
- 1. Videos are available on the USC Marshall Critical Thinking Initiative website to help you better
- understand how to do case analysis and use the Marshall USC-CT framework. Please watch these in
- Week 1. Here is the link.
- 2. Personal assessments are listed in the course schedule and can be accessed via McGraw-Hill Connect,
- Brightspace (Connect module) or a separate website.
- 3. Any additional readings, assessments, and/or materials will be posted to Brightspace.
- 2
- Course Notes
- All course information is available through your Brightspace account. Brightspace is the primary
- channel of communication for this course so take note of announcements and other email messages
- you receive. Assignment and exam scores are posted there as well. You can also communicate directly
- with your Professor, your project team members, and other classmates from your section. Use this link to

- access Brightspace from your web browser and use your USC username and password to log in.
- Course Evaluation
- Participation 15%
 - Active Class Participation
 - Team Engagement
- Research Studies (2)
- Individual Assignments 30%
 - Midterm Exam 15%
 - Case Analysis Assignments 5%
 - Final Reflection Paper 10%
- Team Project 30%
 - Proposal & Team Contract 3%
 - Paper 15%
 - Presentation 10%
- Self & Peer Evaluation 2%
- Final Exam 25%
- Total 100%
- Final grades represent how you perform in the class relative to other students. Three items are considered
- when assigning final grades:
 1. your weighted score as a percentage of the available points for all assignments (the points you receive divided by the number of points possible).
 2. the overall average percentage score within the class.
 3. your ranking among all students in the class.
- Participation
- Attendance Policy. Attendance is critical in this course. All missed classes will be noted. The policy on missed classes is to allow each student two (2) absences, no questions asked, no penalty. Missing three or more classes without a reasonable conversation with the professor will reduce your participation grade and final course grade. Students with an excessive number of absences are at risk of failing the course. Only official university engagements, such as officially scheduled USC Marshall sponsored case competitions and sports events, will be accepted as exceptions to this policy. Job interviews are not excused so choose your absences

- carefully. Habitual lateness and leaving class early, for whatever reason, will be noted as evidence of low
- course commitment and penalized. Simply put, you cannot learn from our class discussions, and your
- classmates cannot learn from you, if you are not present.
- Participation. Your participation grade will be based on consistent and effective contributions to class
- discussions and participation in in-class assignments and activities. You are expected to attend every class
- session having read, thought about, and prepared any assigned material. You should also be prepared to share
- your ideas and to actively listen to and interpret the ideas presented by others. Effective engagement with your
- team is also an important component of your participation grade.
- 3
- Comments that are vague, repetitive, unrelated to the discussion, or disrespectful of others will be evaluated
- negatively. Quality comments possess one or more of the following attributes:
- • Offer a relevant concept or personal experience
- • Provide careful analysis by applying theory and concepts from readings and lectures
- • Move the discussion forward by building on previous contributions with new insights
- • Ask thoughtful and challenging questions.
- Our learning community operates in an environment of openness, respect, encouragement and engagement.
- Discussions will be richer if you share your unique perspective. There is rarely one right answer in
- organizational behavior! It may take courage or patience or imagination to engage with the course material,
- our classmates and our experiences. In our classroom, I aim to develop a psychologically safe space where
- we can all learn together and benefit from the diversity that leads to increased innovation, better problem
- solving and, in our case, what I hope will be new friends and a great semester!
- Research Studies Participation. Please refer to the Research Studies Participation document in Brightspace
- for more information on this component of your grade.
- Individual Assignments
- Midterm Exam. I will give an exam at the midpoint of the course to assess your understanding of material
- previously covered. The exam will consist of multiple-choice, true/false and/or short-essay questions.
- Please refer to the exam study guide posted to Brightspace for information on the topics covered, the format

- of the questions, and sample questions. Make-up exams are not permitted. I expect this exam to be
- administered in person.
- Case Analysis Assignments. To actively engage in case discussions, you will need to complete an analysis
- of the assigned case before attending class. Case preparation goes beyond simply reading the case. You
- are expected to use the USC-CT critical thinking framework to analyze the assigned case. You will identify
- critical problems and develop alternative solutions and an implementation plan. Be sure to watch the
- assigned USC-CT videos as noted in Week 1. Additional instructions will be posted to Brightspace.
- Final Reflection Paper. You will write a short personal reflection paper that describes how your team
- experience was influenced by different group properties and processes as well as reflect on your own
- behavior and learning. You will be assessed based on thoughtful, compelling and insightful writing and
- reflection, a strong connection between the experience and the learning or insights gained, and the use of
- specific detail and narrative accounts that convey an understanding of the experience supported by
- course
- material and personal assessment results. We strongly recommend that you maintain a learning
- journal or
- notes throughout the semester to aid in the writing at the end of the semester. Instructions and a
- grading
- rubric will be posted to Brightspace.
- Team Project
- You will work with your team throughout the semester to prepare for and complete the Team Project. The
- goals of the team project are (1) to enrich your understanding of organizations and leadership; (2) to
- provide
- you with an opportunity to apply what you have learned in the course; (3) to assess your ability to
- analyze
- an organization or organizations and come to insightful conclusions and (4) to help you develop critical
- interpersonal and teamwork skills.
- Your team will have a choice of conducting either:
- 1. A fieldwork study with a local organization such as a student organization, business unit on campus, or
- other local company. Your team will investigate and analyze some aspect of this organization that
- connects with themes in the course such as the organization's culture, rewards system or the structure
- and functioning of groups within the organization. You will identify best practices and make
- recommendations based on your study.
- 4

- 2. An issue analysis of an issue/topic connected to the themes in the course and of importance to multiple organizations; this issue may be inspired by something in the headlines of the business press or something in your own experience. You will need to examine the nature of this issue and analyze in detail how different companies have addressed and/or experienced the issue. You will identify best practices and make recommendations based on your study using archival sources (i.e. library research).
- Your "deliverable" for this project has five components:
 1. Project proposal with team contract
 2. Detailed outline of paper
 3. Project paper
 4. In-class presentation followed by Q&A
 5. Self & peer evaluation feedback (online assessment explained in class).
- Submitted assignments should use 12-point, Times New Roman font, double-spaced, with 1-inch margins on all sides.
- Feedback helps you learn and improve your performance as well as the quality of your output as a team.
- As part of the team project, you will practice and develop skills in providing and receiving effective feedback through in-class exercises and a more formal peer evaluation survey. The criteria for the peer evaluation will be discussed in class and posted to Brightspace.
- The final grade for this project is based on four components: the project proposal, the project paper, the presentation, and the self & peer evaluation. The team project will be evaluated based on the quality of the analysis, the appropriate use of course concepts, principles and frameworks, the logic and substantiation of conclusions, the clarity, organization and style of the writing and the quality of your class presentation. The detailed outline of the paper is not graded but you will receive feedback to help improve the final paper.
- Further instructions and grading rubrics will be posted to Brightspace.
- Grades for individual student contributions to the team project are assigned by your Professor, based on my observations of the team's working dynamics, my assessment of the team project quality, and thoughtful consideration of the information provided through your peer evaluations.
- Final Exam

- The final exam will take place during the final examination period on the date and time assigned by the
- University. It will consist of multiple-choice, true/false and/or short-essay questions. Please refer to the
- exam study guide posted to Brightspace for information on the material covered. If you have another
- final
- exam scheduled on the same date and time as the final exam for this course, you must let me know
- about
- the conflict at least 2 weeks prior to the final exam. I expect this exam to be administered in person.
- Online Class Expectations - IF we move to an online format
- 1. Class attendance and participation are important to develop a coherent view of the materials
- covered in
- the course. Because BUAD 304 is highly interactive and experiential, attendance and active
- participation are required in the event of synchronous Zoom class sessions.
- a. First, please note that BUAD 304 in Fall 2026 is a residential class. All students are expected to be
- physically present in the classroom. In the event you cannot do so, you must contact the professor
- prior to classes beginning. This course is designed for in-person engagement, and OSAS
- Approved/Online only is not allowed at this time.
- 2. In the event we meet online for Zoom sessions, the following netiquette is expected, as if you were
- in
- a physical classroom.
- a. Please DO:
- i. Log into class early or promptly.
- ii. Arrange to attend class where there is a reliable internet connection and without distractions.
- 5
- Course Schedule
- Date Topics Reading & Pework Notes, Deliverables & Due
- D ates
- M Welcome and ARES Reading:
- 8/24 Introduction • Vermeulen, F. (2013). Beware the Sirens
- to the Course of Management Pseudo Science.
- • Pfeffer, J. & Sutton, R. (2011). Trust the
- Evidence, Not Your Instincts
- W Values, Textbook Reading: Chapters 1 & 7 We will complete the VIA
- 8/26 Attitudes & ARES Reading: Park, N. & Peterson, C. Character Strengths
- Ethics (2009) Character Strengths: Research and assessment in class.
- Practice
- Other: Watch the USC-CT and Case
- Analysis videos at this link.

- M Individual Textbook Reading: Ch. 2 & 3 Team project will be explained
- 8/31 Differences Assessments: this week so you can start
- • Self-Assessment 3.01 What is my Big thinking about your topics and
- Five personality profile? on Connect get started on your proposals.
- • Self-Assessment 3.04: What Is Your Level
- of Emotional Intelligence? on Connect
- W Motivation Textbook Reading: Ch. 5 & 6
- 9/2 ARES Reading:
- • Kerr, S. (1995). On the folly of rewarding
- A, while hoping for B
- • Pfeffer, J. (1998). Six dangerous myths
- about pay.
- Assessment(s):
- Self Assessment 5.01 - Assessing Your
- Acquired Needs on Connect
- M Labor Day - No Class
- 9/7
- W Perception & Textbook Reading: Ch. 11 & Ch. 4.1-4.3 We will be forming teams this
- 9/9 Decision- Case Coursepack: Polzer, J. (2018). Trust week. Please do not miss class.
- Making the Algorithm or Your Gut
- Assessment(s):
- • Self-Assessment 11.01 What is my
- intuition? on Connect
- • Self-Assessment 11.02 What is my
- decision-making style? on Connect
- O*NET Interest Profiler . Bring results to
- class.
- M Subarctic Note: Class meets in ELC.
- 9/14 Survival
- Exercise
- 7
- W Power, Textbook Reading: Ch. 12 Thomas Green Case Analysis
- 9/16 Influence & ARES Reading: Memo due
- Networking • Conger, J. (1998). The necessary art of
- persuasion.
- • Cialdini, R. (2001). Harnessing the

- science of persuasion.
- Online Article: Making the Most of the
- Middle (Staples Worklife Magazine article)
- Case Coursepack: Thomas Green: Power,
- Office Politics and a Career in Crisis
- Assessment(s):
 - Self-Assessment 12.01 What kind of
- power do I prefer? on Connect
- Self-Assessment 12.02 Which influence
- tactics do I use? on Connect
- M Black Cat Note: class meets in ELC
- 9/21 Winery
- Exercise
- W In-class
- 9/23 Exercise: 12
- Angry Men
- M Communica- Textbook Reading: Ch. 9 & 10.1-10.4 Team project proposal & team
- 9/28 tion & Listen to: NPR - Why Corporate Jargon contract due
- Conflict Never Seems To Go Away (3-min. audio)
- Assessment(s):
 - Self-Assessment 9.01 Assessing My
- Communication Competence on Connect
- Self-Assessment 10.5 Preferred Conflict
- Handling Style on Connect
- W Negotiation Textbook Reading: Ch. 10.5
- 9/30 ARES Reading: Rutledge, J. (1996). The
- portrait on my office wall.
- M Teaming Teaming Exercise: Please fill out the
- 10/5 Exercise worksheet provided by professor
- Note: Class meets in ELC
- W Fall Recess - No Class
- 10/7
- M Team Project
- 10/12 Workshop I
- W Midterm
- 10/14 Exam

- 8
- M Teams Part 1 Textbook Reading: Ch. 8 Team project outline due
- 10/19 ARES Reading:
- • Coutu, D. (2009). Why teams don't work.
- • Duhigg, C. (2016). What Google Learned
- from its Quest to Build the Perfect Team.
- Watch Video: Teamwork on the Fly (2:31)
- by Prof. Amy Edmonson on HBR Video
- Assessment(s): Self-Assessment 8.01 Group
- and Team Role Preference Scale on Connect
- W Teams Part 2 ARES Reading: SkillsForTomorrow Case
- 10/21 • Katzenbach, J. & Smith, D. (1993). The Analysis Memo Due
- discipline of teams. HBR, March/April issue
- • Ferrazzi, (2013). Getting virtual teams
- right.
- • Earley & Mosakowski (2004). Cultural
- Intelligence. HBR, October issue
- • Meyer (2014). Navigating the Cultural
- Minefield. HBR, May issue
- Watch Video: 5 Dysfunctions of a Team
- (36:18 min)
- Case Coursepack: SkillsForTomorrow
- M Culture and Textbook Reading: Ch. 4.4-4.8
- 10/26 Community Podcast: Knowledge@Wharton: How
- Diversity Powers Team Performance by
- Scott Page
- Case Coursepack:
- • Managing Diversity and Inclusion at Yelp
- W Culture and Watch Video: (TBD)
- 10/28 Community Dimensions of Diversity
- Exercise Stereotypes and Attribution Processes
- Note: Class meets in the classroom
- M Team Project
- 11/2 Workshop II
- W Organiza- Textbook Reading: Ch. 14 & 15 In-class exercise: Map a
- 11/4 tional ARES Reading: Target Organization's

- Structure & • Mercer Delta Consulting. The Congruence Structure & Culture
- Culture Model: A Roadmap for Understanding
- Organizational Performance
- • Griener, L. E. (1998) Evolution and
- revolution as organizations grow
- Online Article: How to make your
- decentralized organization work for you
- Assessment(s): Self-Assessment 14.02:
- What Type of Organizational Culture Do I
- Prefer?
- 9
- Additional Information
- USC Marshall Critical Thinking Initiative
- The USC Marshall Critical Thinking Initiative is a school-wide effort to improve your critical thinking
- skills in order to be more successful problem solvers in class and ultimately in the workplace. This means
- that you will engage in a variety of learning activities in your courses which are aimed at developing and
- applying your critical thinking skills in a disciplined manner so that you can outperform others to get your
- desired job and to further excel in your career. Your ability to think critically is an important part of the
- evaluation/grading process in this course. The centerpiece of Marshall's critical thinking knowledge is a
- website that contains instructional materials and videos. We utilize these resources to prepare you to do the
- case analysis assignments. Here is the link to the website.
- Academic Integrity
- The University of Southern California is foremost a learning community committed to fostering successful
- scholars and researchers dedicated to the pursuit of knowledge and the transmission of ideas. Academic
- misconduct is contrary to this fundamental mission and includes any act of dishonesty in the submission of
- academic work (either in draft or final form), as well as cheating, plagiarism, fabrication (e.g., falsifying
- data), knowingly assisting others in acts of academic dishonesty, and any act that gains or is intended to
- gain an unfair academic advantage. Students are expected to uphold the highest standards of academic

- integrity in all coursework. This course follows the expectations for academic integrity as stated in the USC
- Student Handbook. All students are expected to submit assignments that are original work and prepared
- specifically for the course/section in this academic term. Students may not submit work written by others
- or "recycle" work prepared for other courses without obtaining written permission from the instructor(s).
- Students suspected of academic misconduct will be reported to the Office of Academic Integrity.
- Academic dishonesty has a far-reaching impact and is considered a serious offense against the university.
- Violations will result in a grade penalty, such as a failing grade on the assignment or in the course, and
- disciplinary action from the university, such as suspension or expulsion. For more information about
- academic integrity see the Student Handbook, the Office of Academic Integrity's website, and university
- policies on Research and Scholarship Misconduct. Please ask your instructor if you are unsure what
- constitutes unauthorized assistance on an exam or assignment or what information requires citation and/or
- attribution.
- Instructors determine whether and how generative AI tools (such as ChatGPT, Copilot, Claude, Gemini,
- and similar applications) and other external resources (such as English-language translation tools) may be
- used in this course. Expectations may vary from assignment to assignment. This includes AI tools that
- record, transcribe, or summarize class sessions, which may require express instructor permission.
- Review
- the AI use guidance provided carefully, and direct any questions to your instructor before submitting work.
- Students seeking general guidance may consult the following resources:
- • USC Student Handbook
- • Generative AI General Policy
- • Practical Tips for Using AI in Academic Work
- • Office of Academic Integrity
- Statement Around Use of AI Tools
- Since creating, analytical, and critical thinking skills are part of the learning outcomes of this course, all
- assignments should be prepared by the student working individually or in groups. Students may not have
- another person or entity complete any substantive portion of the assignment. Developing strong

- competencies in these areas will prepare you for a competitive workplace. Additionally, adding copyrighted
- case content to an LLM such as ChatGPT is a violation of our case publisher Harvard University's terms
- of use and copyright. Therefore, using AI tools is prohibited in this course, will be identified as plagiarism,
- and will be reported to the Office of Academic Integrity.

• 11

• === CALENDAR_TABLE_JSON ===

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- Case Analysis Assignments. To actively engage in case discussions, you will need to complete an analysis
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- are expected to use the USC-CT critical thinking framework to analyze the assigned case. You will identify
- critical problems and develop alternative solutions and an implementation plan. Be sure to watch the
- assigned USC-CT videos as noted in Week 1. Additional instructions will be posted to Brightspace.

Full Syllabus Extract

Additional Information USC Marshall Critical Thinking Initiative The USC Marshall Critical Thinking Initiative is a school-wide effort to improve your critical thinking skills in order to be more successful problem solvers in class and ultimately in the workplace. This means that you will engage in a variety of learning activities in your courses which are aimed at developing and applying your critical thinking skills in a disciplined manner so that you can outperform others to get your desired job and to further excel in your career. Your ability to think critically is an important part of the evaluation/grading process in this course. The centerpiece of Marshall's critical thinking knowledge is a website that contains instructional materials and videos. We utilize these resources to prepare you to do the case analysis assignments. Here is the link to the website. Academic Integrity The University of Southern California is foremost a learning community committed to fostering successful scholars and researchers dedicated to the pursuit of knowledge and the transmission of ideas. Academic misconduct is contrary to this fundamental mission and includes any act of dishonesty in the submission of academic work (either in draft or final form), as well as cheating, plagiarism, fabrication (e.g., falsifying data), knowingly assisting others in acts of academic dishonesty, and any act that gains or is intended to gain an unfair academic advantage. Students are expected to uphold the highest standards of academic integrity in all coursework. This course follows the expectations for academic integrity as stated in the USC Student Handbook. All students are expected to submit assignments that are original work and prepared specifically for the course/section in this academic term. Students may not submit work written by others or "recycle" work prepared for other courses without obtaining written permission from the instructor(s). Students suspected of academic misconduct will be reported to the Office of Academic Integrity. Academic dishonesty has a far-reaching impact and is considered a serious offense against the university. Violations will result in a grade penalty, such as a failing grade on the assignment or in the course, and disciplinary action from the university, such as suspension or expulsion. For more information about academic integrity see the Student Handbook, the Office of Academic Integrity's website, and university policies on Research and Scholarship Misconduct. Please ask your instructor if you are unsure what constitutes unauthorized assistance on an exam or assignment or what information requires citation and/or attribution. Instructors determine whether and how generative AI tools (such as ChatGPT, Copilot, Claude, Gemini, and similar applications) and other external resources (such as English-language translation tools) may be used in this course. Expectations may vary from assignment to assignment. This includes AI tools that record, transcribe, or summarize class sessions, which may require express instructor permission. Review the AI use guidance provided carefully, and direct any questions to your instructor before submitting work. Students seeking general guidance may consult the following resources: • USC Student Handbook • Generative AI General Policy • Practical Tips for Using AI in Academic Work • Office of Academic Integrity Statement Around Use of AI Tools Since creating, analytical, and critical thinking skills are part of the learning outcomes of this course, all assignments should be prepared by the student working individually or in groups. Students may not have another person or entity complete any substantive portion of the assignment. Developing strong competencies in these areas will prepare you for a competitive workplace. Additionally, adding copyrighted case content to an LLM such as ChatGPT is a violation of our case publisher Harvard University's terms of use and copyright. Therefore, using AI tools is prohibited in this course, will be identified as plagiarism, and will be reported to the Office of Academic Integrity. 11

Comments that are vague, repetitive, unrelated to the discussion, or disrespectful of others will be evaluated negatively. Quality comments possess one or more of the following attributes: • Offer a relevant concept or personal experience • Provide careful analysis by applying theory and concepts from readings and lectures • Move the discussion forward by building on previous contributions with new insights • Ask thoughtful and challenging questions. Our learning community operates in an environment of openness, respect, encouragement and engagement. Discussions will be richer if you share your unique perspective. There is rarely one right answer in organizational behavior! It may take courage or patience or imagination to engage with the course material, our classmates and our experiences. In our classroom, I aim to develop a psychologically safe space where we can all learn together and benefit from the diversity that leads to increased innovation, better problem solving and, in our case, what I hope will be new friends and a great semester! Research Studies Participation. Please refer to the Research Studies Participation document in Brightspace for more

information on this component of your grade. Individual Assignments Midterm Exam. I will give an exam at the midpoint of the course to assess your understanding of material previously covered. The exam will consist of multiple-choice, true/false and/or short-essay questions. Please refer to the exam study guide posted to Brightspace for information on the topics covered, the format of the questions, and sample questions. Make-up exams are not permitted. I expect this exam to be administered in person. Case Analysis Assignments. To actively engage in case discussions, you will need to complete an analysis of the assigned case before attending class. Case preparation goes beyond simply reading the case. You are expected to use the USC-CT critical thinking framework to analyze the assigned case. You will identify critical problems and develop alternative solutions and an implementation plan. Be sure to watch the assigned USC-CT videos as noted in Week 1. Additional instructions will be posted to Brightspace. Final Reflection Paper. You will write a short personal reflection paper that describes how your team experience was influenced by different group properties and processes as well as reflect on your own behavior and learning. You will be assessed based on thoughtful, compelling and insightful writing and reflection, a strong connection between the experience and the learning or insights gained, and the use of specific detail and narrative accounts that convey an understanding of the experience supported by course material and personal assessment results. We strongly recommend that you maintain a learning journal or notes throughout the semester to aid in the writing at the end of the semester. Instructions and a grading rubric will be posted to Brightspace. Team Project You will work with your team throughout the semester to prepare for and complete the Team Project. The goals of the team project are (1) to enrich your understanding of organizations and leadership; (2) to provide you with an opportunity to apply what you have learned in the course; (3) to assess your ability to analyze an organization or organizations and come to insightful conclusions and (4) to help you develop critical interpersonal and teamwork skills. Your team will have a choice of conducting either: 1. A fieldwork study with a local organization such as a student organization, business unit on campus, or other local company. Your team will investigate and analyze some aspect of this organization that connects with themes in the course such as the organization's culture, rewards system or the structure and functioning of groups within the organization. You will identify best practices and make recommendations based on your study. 4

2. An issue analysis of an issue/topic connected to the themes in the course and of importance to multiple organizations; this issue may be inspired by something in the headlines of the business press or something in your own experience. You will need to examine the nature of this issue and analyze in detail how different companies have addressed and/or experienced the issue. You will identify best practices and make recommendations based on your study using archival sources (i.e. library research). Your "deliverable" for this project has five components: 1. Project proposal with team contract 2. Detailed outline of paper 3. Project paper 4. In-class presentation followed by Q&A 5. Self & peer evaluation feedback (online assessment explained in class). Submitted assignments should use 12-point, Times New Roman font, double-spaced, with 1-inch margins on all sides. Feedback helps you learn and improve your performance as well as the quality of your output as a team. As part of the team project, you will practice and develop skills in providing and receiving effective feedback through in-class exercises and a more formal peer evaluation survey. The criteria for the peer evaluation will be discussed in class and posted to Brightspace. The final grade for this project is based on four components: the project proposal, the project paper, the presentation, and the self & peer evaluation. The team project will be evaluated based on the quality of the analysis, the appropriate use of course concepts, principles and frameworks, the logic and substantiation of conclusions, the clarity, organization and style of the writing and the quality of your class presentation. The detailed outline of the paper is not graded but you will receive feedback to help improve the final paper. Further instructions and grading rubrics will be posted to Brightspace. Grades for individual student contributions to the team project are assigned by your Professor, based on my observations of the team's working dynamics, my assessment of the team project quality, and thoughtful consideration of the information provided through your peer evaluations. Final Exam The final exam will take place during the final examination period on the date and time assigned by the University. It will consist of multiple-choice, true/false and/or short-essay questions. Please refer to the exam study guide posted to Brightspace for information on the material covered. If you have another final exam scheduled on the same date and time as the final exam for this course, you must let me know about the conflict at least 2 weeks prior to the final exam. I expect this exam to be administered in person. Online Class Expectations - IF we move to an online format 1. Class attendance and participation are important to develop a coherent view of the materials

covered in the course. Because BUAD 304 is highly interactive and experiential, attendance and active participation are required in the event of synchronous Zoom class sessions. a. First, please note that BUAD 304 in Fall 2026 is a residential class. All students are expected to be physically present in the classroom. In the event you cannot do so, you must contact the professor prior to classes beginning. This course is designed for in-person engagement, and OSAS Approved/Online only is not allowed at this time. 2. In the event we meet online for Zoom sessions, the following netiquette is expected, as if you were in a physical classroom. a. Please DO: i. Log into class early or promptly. ii. Arrange to attend class where there is a reliable internet connection and without distractions. 5

Our Inclusive Learning Community USC is a multicultural community of people from diverse gender, racial, ethnic and class backgrounds, national origins, faith backgrounds, political beliefs, abilities, and sexual orientations. Our lectures, classes, programs, workshops, activities and everyday interactions are enriched by our acceptance of one another, and we strive to learn from each other in an atmosphere of mutual respect and positive engagement. As Trojans, we understand the value of the perspectives of individuals from all backgrounds that reflect the rich diversity of our USC community and beyond. Together, we will strive to make this classroom a psychologically safe and inclusive environment for all of us to develop and practice inclusive behaviors. As such, we will: • respect the dignity and essential work of all individuals, • promote a culture of respect within the university community, • respect the privacy, property, and freedom of others, • reject bigotry, discrimination, violence or intimidation of any kind, • practice personal and academic integrity and expect it of others, and • promote the diversity of opinions, ideas and backgrounds which is the lifeblood of the university. Course Materials (1) Textbook & Connect/LearnSmart. You will need the ONLINE version of Organizational Behavior: A Practical, Problem-Solving Approach 3rd edition by Angelo Kinicki. 2021. McGraw Hill. USC has a new Digital Course Materials Program which provides access to many required textbooks, case studies and other resources for one flat fee. Our course materials have been submitted to the program coordinator and students have been sent notification about how to access the materials. Please check your usc.edu email for instructions on how to access the materials. I strongly recommend you access the textbook through this program, as the price for the e-book and Connect will be a significant discount relative to purchasing the book independent from the Course Materials Program. To gain access to the required ONLINE version of our textbook, Organizational Behavior: A Practical, Problem-Solving Approach, 3rd edition by Angelo Kinicki (2021) via Brightspace, follow these instructions to register directly with McGraw Hill. 1. Sign in to Brightspace. 2. Go to our BUAD 304 Organizational Behavior and Leadership course. 3. Under Content, find the Connect module and go to that module. 4. Click on one of the assignments in the Connect module (e.g., What is My Big Five Personality Profile), and you will jump over to the McGraw Hill website to register and access the e-book. 5. Please review the video at this link for additional information. (2) ARES Course Reader. This course reader is accessible for free on the USC Libraries ARES system online. Go to the online ARES system, click on Search Courses and search by course number: 304 for Fall 2026. Once you find the BUAD 304 course, add it then click View Course to view and access the readings. (3) Case reader. The BUAD 304 Organizational Behavior & Leadership coursepack for Fall 2026 can be accessed via the email sent to you. Additional Readings, Resources and Assessments 1. Videos are available on the USC Marshall Critical Thinking Initiative website to help you better understand how to do case analysis and use the Marshall USC-CT framework. Please watch these in Week 1. Here is the link. 2. Personal assessments are listed in the course schedule and can be accessed via McGraw-Hill Connect, Brightspace (Connect module) or a separate website. 3. Any additional readings, assessments, and/or materials will be posted to Brightspace. 2

Course Notes All course information is available through your Brightspace account. Brightspace is the primary channel of communication for this course so take note of announcements and other email messages you receive. Assignment and exam scores are posted there as well. You can also communicate directly with your Professor, your project team members, and other classmates from your section. Use this link to access Brightspace from your web browser and use your USC username and password to log in. Course Evaluation Participation 15% Active Class Participation Team Engagement Research Studies (2) Individual Assignments 30% Midterm Exam 15% Case Analysis Assignments 5% Final Reflection Paper 10% Team Project 30% Proposal & Team Contract 3% Paper 15% Presentation 10% Self & Peer

Evaluation 2% Final Exam 25% Total 100% Final grades represent how you perform in the class relative to other students. Three items are considered when assigning final grades: 1. your weighted score as a percentage of the available points for all assignments (the points you receive divided by the number of points possible). 2. the overall average percentage score within the class. 3. your ranking among all students in the class. Participation Attendance Policy. Attendance is critical in this course. All missed classes will be noted. The policy on missed classes is to allow each student two (2) absences, no questions asked, no penalty. Missing three or more classes without a reasonable conversation with the professor will reduce your participation grade and final course grade. Students with an excessive number of absences are at risk of failing the course. Only official university engagements, such as officially scheduled USC Marshall sponsored case competitions and sports events, will be accepted as exceptions to this policy. Job interviews are not excused so choose your absences carefully. Habitual lateness and leaving class early, for whatever reason, will be noted as evidence of low course commitment and penalized. Simply put, you cannot learn from our class discussions, and your classmates cannot learn from you, if you are not present. Participation. Your participation grade will be based on consistent and effective contributions to class discussions and participation in in-class assignments and activities. You are expected to attend every class session having read, thought about, and prepared any assigned material. You should also be prepared to share your ideas and to actively listen to and interpret the ideas presented by others. Effective engagement with your team is also an important component of your participation grade. 3

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M Teams Part 1 Textbook Reading: Ch. 8 Team project outline due 10/19 ARES Reading: • Coutu, D. (2009). Why teams don't work. • Duhigg, C. (2016). What Google Learned from its Quest to Build the Perfect Team. Watch Video: Teamwork on the Fly (2:31) by Prof. Amy Edmonson on HBR Video Assessment(s): Self-Assessment 8.01 Group and Team Role Preference Scale on Connect W Teams Part 2 ARES Reading: SkillsForTomorrow Case 10/21 • Katzenbach, J. & Smith, D. (1993). The Analysis Memo Due discipline of teams. HBR, March/April issue • Ferrazzi, (2013). Getting virtual teams right. • Earley & Mosakowski (2004). Cultural Intelligence. HBR, October issue • Meyer (2014). Navigating the Cultural Minefield. HBR, May issue Watch Video: 5 Dysfunctions of a Team (36:18 min) Case Coursepack: SkillsForTomorrow M Culture and Textbook Reading: Ch. 4.4-4.8 10/26 Community Podcast: Knowledge@Wharton: How Diversity Powers Team Performance by Scott Page Case Coursepack: • Managing Diversity and Inclusion at Yelp W Culture and Watch Video: (TBD) 10/28 Community Dimensions of Diversity E xercise

Stereotypes and Attribution Processes Note: Class meets in the classroom M Team Project 11/2 Workshop II W
 Organiza- Textbook Reading: Ch. 14 & 15 In-class exercise: Map a 11/4 tional ARES Reading: Target Organization's
 Structure & • Mercer Delta Consulting. The Congruence Structure & Culture Culture Model: A Roadmap for
 Understanding Organizational Performance • Griener, L. E. (1998) Evolution and revolution as organizations grow
 Online Article: How to make your decentralized organization work for you Assessment(s): Self-Assessment 14.02: What
 Type of Organizational Culture Do I Prefer? 9

Course Schedule Date Topics Reading & Pework Notes, Deliverables & Due D ates M Welcome and ARES Reading:
 8/24 Introduction • Vermeulen, F. (2013). Beware the Sirens to the Course of Management Pseudo Science. • Pfeffer, J.
 & Sutton, R. (2011). Trust the Evidence, Not Your Instincts W Values, Textbook Reading: Chapters 1 & 7 We will
 complete the VIA 8/26 Attitudes & ARES Reading: Park, N. & Peterson, C. Character Strengths Ethics (2009) Character
 Strengths: Research and assessment in class. Practice Other: Watch the USC-CT and Case Analysis videos at this link.
 M Individual Textbook Reading: Ch. 2 & 3 Team project will be explained 8/31 Differences Assessments: this week so
 you can start • Self-Assessment 3.01 What is my Big thinking about your topics and Five personality profile? on Connect
 get started on your proposals. • Self-Assessment 3.04: What Is Your Level of Emotional Intelligence? on Connect W
 Motivation Textbook Reading: Ch. 5 & 6 9/2 ARES Reading: • Kerr, S. (1995). On the folly of rewarding A, while hoping
 for B • Pfeffer, J. (1998). Six dangerous myths about pay. Assessment(s): Self Assessment 5.01 - Assessing Your
 Acquired Needs on Connect M Labor Day - No Class 9/7 W Perception & Textbook Reading: Ch. 11 & Ch. 4.1-4.3 We
 will be forming teams this 9/9 Decision- Case Coursepack: Polzer, J. (2018). Trust week. Please do not miss class.
 Making the Algorithm or Your Gut Assessment(s): • Self-Assessment 11.01 What is my intuition? on Connect •
 Self-Assessment 11.02 What is my decision-making style? on Connect O*NET Interest Profiler . Bring results to class. M
 Subarctic Note: Class meets in ELC. 9/14 Survival Exercise 7

W Power, Textbook Reading: Ch. 12 Thomas Green Case Analysis 9/16 Influence & ARES Reading: Memo due
 Networking • Conger, J. (1998). The necessary art of persuasion. • Cialdini, R. (2001). Harnessing the science of
 persuasion. Online Article: Making the Most of the Middle (Staples Worklife Magazine article) Case Coursepack:
 Thomas Green: Power, Office Politics and a Career in Crisis Assessment(s): • Self-Assessment 12.01 What kind of
 power do I prefer? on Connect • Self-Assessment 12.02 Which influence tactics do I use? on Connect M Black Cat Note:
 class meets in ELC 9/21 Winery Exercise W In-class 9/23 Exercise: 12 Angry Men M Communica- Textbook Reading:
 Ch. 9 & 10.1-10.4 Team project proposal & team 9/28 tion & Listen to: NPR - Why Corporate Jargon contract due
 Conflict Never Seems To Go Away (3-min. audio) Assessment(s): • Self-Assessment 9.01 Assessing My
 Communication Competence on Connect • Self-Assessment 10.5 Preferred Conflict Handling Style on Connect W
 Negotiation Textbook Reading: Ch. 10.5 9/30 ARES Reading: Rutledge, J. (1996). The portrait on my office wall. M
 Teaming Teaming Exercise: Please fill out the 10/5 Exercise worksheet provided by professor N ote: Class meets in
 ELC W Fall Recess - No Class 10/7 M Team Project 10/12 Workshop I W Midterm 10/14 Exam 8